



Mason

mason • 3-4 year apprenticeship

\$45K-\$70K / yr

THE TRADE

Build and finish walls, patios, foundations, and architectural details from brick, block, and stone. Masonry blends physical work with genuine artistry — craftsmanship that outlives the builder — with steady demand across residential and commercial construction.

SALARY & TRAINING

JOURNEYMAN BAND (SITE FIGURE — SAME AS QUIZ RESULT & TRADES PAGE)

\$45K-\$70K

Site band (trades page / quiz) • 3-4 yr apprenticeship • no dedicated salary post yet — assumed

THE PATH: FROM RESEARCH TO HIRED

01 RESEARCH Compare training routes, union vs non-union, and local demand

02 TRAIN Trade school / pre-apprenticeship — start with OSHA 10

03 HANDS-ON Apprentice years: log hours, earn raises to 80-90% of scale

04 CERTIFIED Pass the journeyman or industry certification exam

05 HIRED Journey-level pay — specialize, stack certs, own the shop

Every apprentice track pays from day one — typical start is 40-50% of journey scale with scheduled raises every year. Each step above is fully mapped on the TradeLift Getting Started guide and the site's resources page.



Mason — Roadmap, page 2

CERTIFICATIONS + FIRST 12 WEEKS

REQUIRED CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

OSHA 10 Hour — the universal entry credential

YOUR FIRST 12 WEEKS — THE ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Take the TradeLift quiz to confirm fit
- ☐ Earn your OSHA 10 online
- ☐ Get First Aid/CPR certified
- ☐ Draft a one-page trade resume
- ☐ Call the local bricklayers' union / IMB
- ☐ Search apprenticeship.gov masonry r
- ☐ Buy a trowel, brick hammer, chalk line
- ☐ Practice laying a test block course
- ☐ Mix and set slabs for repetition reps
- ☐ Volunteer on a wall or patio project
- ☐ Apply to 2-3 masonry apprenticeships
- ☐ Shadow a mason one working day

Full career steps, certifications, and tool guides: <https://tradelift.surge.sh/getting-started.html>